Six math clues · answer key

How Velcro Works

Compare tens first, then ones. For rounding, 5 or more ones rounds up.

Math 1 · 84

48 < 84. Compare the tens first, so the greater count is 84.

Math 2 · 63

63 > 36. Compare the tens first, so the greater count is 63.

Math 3 · 55

55 = 55. Both counts match, so the shared count is 55.

Math 4 · 30

27 has 7 ones, so round up to 30.

Math 5 · 70

74 has 4 ones, so round down to 70.

Math 6 · 50

45 has 5 ones, so round up to 50.

Three two-digit comparisons and three nearest-ten roundings. The numbers are for practice, not real hook counts.

Reading & writing · answer key

How Velcro Works

Reading · 1

Hook and loop; Velcro is a company name.

Reading · 2

Each burr spine ended in a tiny hook that caught loops.

Reading · 3

Hooks catch loops; hundreds of hooks share the pull.

Reading · 4

A peel opens one thin line of hooks at a time.

Reading · 5

The bag pulls along the strip, so every hook shares the load.

Reading · 6

Lint fills the hooks, so they cannot reach the loops.

Math · all

84, 63, 55, 30, 70, 50.

Screen-free

A burr gave the idea; hooks catch loops; a peel opens easily; lint clogs hooks.

Burrs are for looking, not for faces or mouths; wash hands after handling plants. Pipe cleaner ends can poke: bend them over. Comb strips gently.

Offer dictation: let the child say a complete thought while you write it, then invite a picture or label.

Four looks at a strap

How Velcro Works

Quiz 1. Where did the idea come from?

Burdock burrs have spines that end in tiny hooks.

Quiz 2. What do the hooks catch?

Stiff hooks on one strip catch soft loops on the other.

Quiz 3. Which way opens easily?

A peel lets go of one thin line of hooks at a time.

Quiz 4. Why do old strips grip less?

Lint and fluff clog the hooks, so they cannot reach the loops.

Burrs are for looking, not for faces or mouths; wash hands after handling plants. Pipe cleaner ends can poke: bend them over. Comb strips gently.